CYBER SAFETY GUY

PINTEREST
A PARENT'S GUIDE

Pinterest is a visual discovery platform where people save ideas, find inspiration and plan for the future. It can be a positive space, but it also has content that's not always suitable for children.

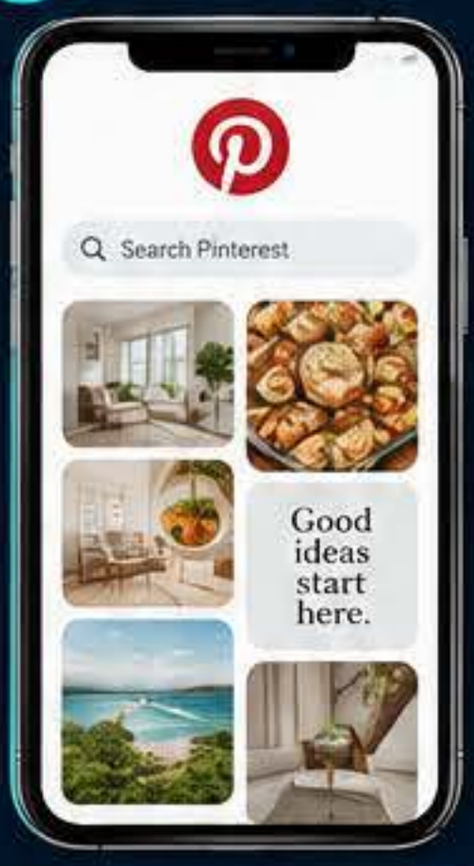
450M+
monthly active users worldwide (2024).

13+
recommended minimum age (although it's not strictly enforced).

PRIVATE BY DEFAULT
Accounts are private unless set to public.

GREAT FOR
creativity, learning, recipes, home ideas and future planning.

1 WHAT IS PINTEREST?



Users save and organise images (pins) into boards.

It's a mix of ideas, trends, how-to guides and shopping inspiration.

You can follow creators, brands and topics that interest you.

Content can be public or private, and much of it is shared by people around the world.

2 WHAT YOUR CHILD MIGHT SEE

Inspiration	Ideas for fashion, beauty, home, travel, food and more.
Wellbeing & lifestyle	Fitness, mental health, self-care and productivity tips.
Education	Study tips, career ideas and how-to guides.
Shopping	Product recommendations, hauls and brand content.
More adult content	Some pins can include mature or explicit images and themes, often disguised as 'aesthetic' or 'inspiration'.

TIP: Use safe search and content filters to help limit what your child can see.

3 KEY SAFETY SETTINGS

Privacy	Keep accounts private and limit who can follow or message your child.
Content preferences	Turn on 'sensitive content filtering' and hide certain topics.
Follow & save	Review who they follow and what they save.
Notifications	Control what they're alerted to (e.g. messages, mentions).

Check settings regularly, as they can change with updates.

4 POTENTIAL RISKS

Exposure to inappropriate content
Mature, graphic or harmful content can appear, especially through search or related pins.

Body image & comparison
Can lead to unrealistic expectations and low self-esteem.

Ads & influencer content
Product and lifestyle content can promote unrealistic or unsafe behaviours.

Contact from strangers
Some users may try to engage with children through messages or comments.

Location sharing
Pins can reveal personal details, including where you live, work or go to school.

5 TALKING POINTS

- What do you like to look at on Pinterest and why?
- Have you seen any pins that made you feel uncomfortable or confused?
- Do you know how to report something if it upsets you?
- Who would you talk to if you saw something that worried you?

Keep the conversation open. Curiosity builds trust.

6 BEST PRACTICES

Think before you pin
Be mindful of what you save, share and show others.

Keep personal info private
Don't share your location, school, or details about your life.

Follow safe accounts
Stick to trusted creators and brands.

Report & block
Use the reporting tools if you see something harmful or upsetting.

GOOD TO KNOW

Pinterest is not just for kids – many adults use it too.

The goal isn't to restrict, but to help your child navigate it safely and confidently.

7 QUICK START FOR PARENTS

1. Review your child's privacy and content settings.
2. Explore Pinterest together and talk about what they enjoy.
3. Show them how to report and block.
4. Keep the conversation going – regularly.

A few minutes now can prevent bigger problems later.

8 WHERE TO GET HELP

Childline: 0800 1111
childline.org.uk

Free, confidential support for any child or young person. You can talk about anything.

The Mix
0808 808 4994
themix.org.uk
Support for under 25s.

Internet Matters
internetmatters.org
Advice, guides and tools for parents.

STAY CURIOUS. | STAY INVOLVED. | KEEP THE CONVERSATION GOING.

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